

WHO'S BETTING WHAT

The next battleground for quick commerce companies is moving beyond the grocery basket

PLATFORM	MODEL	PRIVATE LABELS	KEY BET	CORE STRATEGY
 Amazon Now	Seller-led/ marketplace	Solimo	Grocery + FMCG	Scale
 BigBasket	Inventory-led	Fresho, Tasties, BB Home, BB Royal	Grocery	Grocery + quick commerce expansion
 Blinkit	Inventory-led	Whole Farm	Grocery + non food	Scale + profitability
 Flipkart Minutes	Seller-led/ marketplace	Pykd, Flipkart Smartbuy	General merchandise + grocery	Scale
 Instamart	Moving towards inventory model	Supreme Harvest, Noice, Nectr	Grocery + higher-margin categories	Margin reset
 Zepto	Inventory/ marketplace	Daily Good, Chyll	Grocery + BPC (beauty & personal care);	Scale + IPO

NOTE PRIVATE-LABEL PRESENCE IS BASED ON INDUSTRY ANALYSTS' ESTIMATES AND IS INDICATIVE, AS PLATFORMS USE DIFFERENT DEFINITIONS AND DO NOT UNIFORMLY DISCLOSE PRIVATE-LABEL CONTRIBUTION

SOURCE INDUSTRY/ANALYSTS

then you make it operationally perfect in terms of delivery timelines, store efficiencies, etc,” says Apoorve Goyal, Managing Director, India Investments at Prosus, one of Swiggy’s largest investors.

As per experts, Blinkit can command a price premium even on identical SKUs, around 15% more expensive than offline retail, 10% higher than Instamart and 5% higher than Zepto. That pricing power also allows it to sell adjacent categories, further improving its economics.

Deloitte’s Anand Ramanathan, Consumer Industry Leader and Partner at Deloitte South Asia, says the other critical piece is operational discipline. “It is focused on a path to profitability, looking at where they will knock down cost and add efficiencies,” he adds.

What has also changed is the metrics investors watch out for. In a business where revenue and order growth can mask heavy cash burn, money lost per order is increasingly becoming the more telling met-

ric, says Satish Meena, founder, Datum Intelligence, a market analytics firm. Blinkit’s ability to move that number into the positive territory gives it an advantage that its rivals are trying to replicate.

THE PROFIT MATH

There is an irony at the heart of India’s quick-commerce shake-up. While the companies are fighting harder than ever, the market itself is nowhere near saturated. Navin Killa, Head of Asian Telecoms, Media and Internet Research at UBS Global Research, believes the size of the opportunity explains the influx of competition.

When quick commerce began taking off in 2021, investors and analysts saw it as a \$15-20 billion market, he says. At that size, it may have been logical to leave the market to the three pure-play companies. But as the platforms expanded beyond grocery and demonstrated that the opportunity could be much larger, other companies entered the fray.